Revision Date:
09/01/2026

Background:
Resources are considered in the CalFresh eligibility determination. A household's (HH's) non-exempt resources must not exceed the property limit for the HH type and size.

Purpose:
This section details the CalFresh resource evaluation policy. This section is being updated to include the treatment of HH composition changes reported during the certification period.

Policy:
HHs that have been determined to be Categorically Eligible (CE) or Modified Categorically Eligible (MCE) are not required to have resources evaluated. Refer to Section 63-120 for information on determining CE and MCE eligibility. For HHs who are not CE or MCE, verify and determine the value of the HH's resources. Evaluate resources at initial application, periodic report, recertification, or when adding a new HH member. A HH whose resources exceed the maximum allowable non-exempt property limit will be determined ineligible for CalFresh. Refer to Section 63-1101 for the current maximum allowable resource limit.

1. Countable Resources

Include the following types of resources in the evaluation for CalFresh at application, periodic report, and recertification:

- Liquid resources such as cash on hand, money in checking and savings accounts, savings certificates, stocks or bonds, non-recurring lump sum payments, funds held in Individual Retirement Accounts (IRAs), and in accessible Keogh plans, provided they are not excluded as described below.
  Note: The value of an IRA or Keogh is the total cash value minus the amount of the penalty for early withdrawal of the entire amount in the plan.
- Non-liquid resources such as personal property, land, buildings, and recreational properties provided they are not excluded as described below.
  Note: The value of non-liquid resources is the equity value, which is the fair market value less any loans owed on the resource.

2. Treatment of Resources

The following table describes how to treat resources in different eligibility circumstances:

Circumstance	Treatment of Resources
Joint Ownership of Resources	Resources owned jointly by separate HHs (including non-CalFresh HHs) will be considered entirely available to the HH, unless the HH can demonstrate that the resources are inaccessible. If the HH can demonstrate having access to only a portion of a resource, the value of only the accessible portion will be counted toward the HH's resource level.

	The resource will be considered inaccessible to the HH if the resource cannot practically be subdivided and the HH's access to the value of the resource is dependent on the agreement of a joint owner who refuses to comply. A resource cannot be practically subdivided if the financial value of the proportionate share would be significantly reduced by the sale of only the subdivision. If a resource is jointly held by members of the same CalFresh HH and some receive Public Assistance (PA) and others do not, the amount counted in determining the PA eligibility will be excluded. Bank accounts held jointly with military personnel deployed overseas will be excluded when the HH cannot use the funds for its own purposes, and only has access to the account to pay bills for the service member. It is the responsibility of the applicant to provide verification of this arrangement. • Verification may be a written statement from the military service person, a statement from the bank or other means attesting to this arrangement. • The funds will be counted as a resource for the HH if the customer has access to the service member's bank account for their own purposes.
Resources of Excluded HH Members	The resources of excluded and ineligible HH members such as ineligible non-citizens, Social Security Number (SSN) Disqualified, Intentional Program Violators (IPV), Fleeing Felons and Probation/Parole Violators, CalFresh Employment and Training (CFET) Sanctioned, and Able-Bodied Adult Without Dependents (ABAWD) individuals not meeting work requirements will count in their entirety to the remaining HH members. The resources of ineligible students will be considered unavailable to the remaining HH members.
Resources for HHs with Sponsored Non-Citizens	The resources of a sponsor and the sponsor's spouse (if the spouse signed the United States Citizenship and Immigration Services [USCIS] Form I-864 or I-864A) will be deemed to the sponsored non-citizen and will be considered in determining the HH's eligibility. • The amount deemed to the non-citizen's HH will be the total amount of the sponsor's resources reduced by $1,500. If a sponsored non-citizen verifies that their sponsor is responsible for other sponsored non-citizens, the sponsor's resources will be deemed and divided equally among all sponsored individuals applying for or receiving CalFresh.

	• If the non-citizen does not provide verification, the full resource amount will be deemed to the applicant until the information is received. If the non-citizen changes sponsors during the certification period, deemed resources will be recalculated using the new sponsor's information.
Resources of Residents in Battered Person Shelters	Eligible residents of shelters for battered persons must be certified based on the resources the HH members have on the date of application, and their resource level as of the date of their interview. If resources are held jointly with members of their former HH from which they fled and access to the resources requires consent of the former HH member, those resources will be considered inaccessible.

3. Resource Evaluations

Evaluate resource eligibility for HHs that are non-CE and non-MCE at application, Eligibility Status Report (SAR 7) and at recertification. Use the information reported on the application, SAR 7, and recertification forms to determine continuing eligibility for the certification period or remaining months of the certification period.

- CalFresh HHs are not required to report any changes related to property mid-period; do not take action mid-period on any voluntary reported change in property that will result in a decrease or discontinuance of benefits.
- Discontinue the case at the end of the SAR 7 or recertification submit month with timely notice if the HH exceeds the resource limit based on property reported. If the HH provides verification that their resources are within the resource limit prior to the effective date of discontinuance, rescind the negative action as long as the HH continues to meet all other CalFresh eligibility criteria.

4. HH Composition Changes Reported During the Certification Period

When a non-CE and non-MCE HH reports a new HH member, it is considered Verified Upon Receipt (VUR) and must be acted on promptly. The new HH member's income, resources, and other eligibility factors must be evaluated to determine the HH's continued eligibility and benefit level. The following scenarios demonstrate appropriate actions to take:

Scenario 1: A non-CE and non-MCE HH voluntarily reports a new HH member and provides adequate information and verification.

If the reported change would result in…	**then…**
a decrease or discontinuance of benefits,	do not add the new HH member, send the HH a no-change NOA, document the information in the case record, and follow-up on the HH composition change at the next mandatory report (SAR 7 or recertification).
an increase in benefits,	add the new HH member and re-evaluate CalFresh eligibility.

Scenario 2: A non-CE and non-MCE HH voluntarily reports a new HH member and does not provide adequate information or verification. As a result, it is unknown how adding the new HH member will impact the HH's benefits and a CW 2200 must be sent to request necessary information or verification.

If the HH…	then…
provides the required information and/or verification and the reported change would result in a decrease or discontinuance of CalFresh benefits,	do not add the new HH member, send the HH a no-change NOA, document the information in the case record, and follow-up on the HH composition change at the next mandatory report (SAR 7 or recertification).
provides the required information and/or verification and the reported change would result in an increase in benefits,	add the new HH member and re-evaluate CalFresh eligibility.
does not provide adequate information and/or verification to add the new HH member,	do not add the new HH member, send the HH a no-change NOA, document the information in the case record, and follow-up on the HH composition change at the next mandatory report (SAR 7 or recertification).

5. Transfer of Resources

During initial application, the HH must provide information regarding resources that have been transferred within the three-month period immediately preceding the date of application. This includes excluded HH members' resources that are considered available to the HH. The following resource transfers will not affect eligibility to the CalFresh program:

- Excluded resources.
- Have been sold or traded at, or near, fair market value.
- Transferred between members of the same HH, including ineligible non-citizens or disqualified HH members, whose resources are considered available to the HH.
- Transferred for reasons other than qualifying or attempting to qualify for CalFresh benefits, for example, a parent placing funds into an educational trust fund.

Applicants who knowingly transfer resources for the purpose of qualifying for CalFresh benefits will be denied and sent a Notice of Action (NOA) explaining the denial reason and disqualification period. The disqualification period will begin with the month of application. HHs that are already participating when the transfer is discovered will be discontinued and sent a NOA explaining the discontinuance reason and length of the disqualification period. The disqualification period will begin with the first day of the month following timely notice.

Determine the length of the disqualification period by:

- Adding the value of the transferred resource to the total countable resource value.
- Subtract the resource limit from the total amount of resource value.
- The amount over the resource limit is used to determine the length of the disqualification period.

Use the following chart to determine the length of the disqualification period:

Amount in Excess of Resource Limit	Period of Disqualification
$0 to 249.99	1 month
$250-999.99	3 months
$1,000 to 2,999.99	6 months
$3,000 to 4,999.99	9 months
$5,000 or more	12 months

Example: A one-person HH with $2,000 in the bank, transfers a vacation property to a relative. The disqualification period is computed as follows:

Step	Action
1	$3,050 vacation property +$2,000 (bank account) = $5,050 (total resources)
2	$5,050 (total resources) -$3,000 (resource limit as of 10/1/2025) =$2,050 (excess resources)
3	$2,050 excess resources disqualify the HH for a period of 6 months according to the chart above

Note: A transfer of resources to qualify for CalFresh will not be treated as a fraudulent action in and of itself. However, concealment and misrepresentation of the resources transferred will constitute fraud and will be subject to the intentional program violation provisions.

References:
Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) 63-501, 63-503.44-.45
All County Letter (ACL) 13-32, 21-101E
Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) Title 7 Section 273.8

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by 08/31/2029

Approval for Release:

9/2/24

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